

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, Digital Payments.*

Positioning, payments product manager with 13 years in regulated industries, a fintech founding track, and hands-on API and partner integration experience.

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Dear Hiring Team at 7X,

Digital payments product management is where I have spent the most consequential part of my career. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P group-payments product built from zero, taken to acquisition, and operated inside the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem. That experience taught me early what it means to own a payment product end to end, not just the roadmap and the user stories, but the partner onboarding, the reconciliation edge cases, the bank relationships, and the moments when a missed requirement surfaces as a settlement failure at 11pm on a Friday.

The Product Manager, Digital Payments role at 7X sits at the intersection of partner integrations, MTO relationships, bank connectivity, and CBUAE regulatory compliance. That is a familiar shape of problem. At Scheidt & Bachmann Fuel & Convenience Retail, I owned the integration product team in a SAFe organisation spanning POS systems, forecourt hardware, and payment flows across a matrix of stakeholders. I moved research results into production by managing the dependency web, between agile release trains, external vendors, and internal operations, rather than hoping it would resolve itself. At EMIL Group, I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week, both by applying MVP discipline: agree what counts as done, build the smallest thing that proves it, iterate with data.

On the technical side, I work directly with APIs and integration teams. I can read a REST API specification, write a test harness, and identify the edge cases that will cause problems before they reach QA. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I drove the ETL migration and containerisation programme while simultaneously carrying a full UI relaunch, because a product manager who cannot navigate a technical conversation with the team is a bottleneck, not a bridge. I bring the same fluency to partner API integrations: I do not just hand off a requirements document, I stay in the room until the integration works.

I am aware that I am not yet a holder of CBUAE-specific regulatory experience. I am also aware that this gap is a ramp, not a wall, the compliance mechanics of payment product management translate across jurisdictions, and I have a track record of getting up to speed in regulated environments quickly. My willingness to relocate to Abu Dhabi or Dubai is genuine, not hedged: the UAE is an active target in my search, not a stretch.

I would welcome a conversation about the specific partner integration challenges on your current roadmap and where you feel the product function needs the most support.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
